[1] Professional football player Lionel Messi was born on June 24, 1987, in Rosario, Argentina. He started football at the age of 8, playing for the Newell's Old Boys - a team in his **native town**.

[2] As a kid, Messi was smaller than most of the boys he played with; he was suffering from a hormone deficiency that restricted his growth. Medication was costly and Messi's parents couldn't pay for it. At the age of 13, Messi was offered an opportunity to play for Barcelona and have his medical bills paid by the team. So, the whole family moved across the Atlantic to Spain.

[3] Messi was famous for being short and rapid with a fierce style of play. He was soon compared to another well-known Argentinean footballer: Diego Maradona. Messi moved quickly through the ranks of the team's junior system, and by the age of 16, he had made his first appearance for Barcelona. He put himself in the record books on May 1, 2005, as the youngest player to ever score a goal. That same year he led Argentina to the title in the under-20 World Cup.

[4] In recent years Messi has become one of the highest paid football players, earning an estimated $18 million a year. He has justified that he is worth that price by leading Barcelona to a lot of success; the left-footer's **team** won the Champions League, La Liga, and Spanish Club titles in 2009. That same year, he took home the FIFA World Player of the Year award.

[5] Even Maradona, the renowned retired player, has praised Messi. "I see him as very similar to me," he told the BBC. "He's a leader and is offering lessons in beautiful football. **He** has something different from any other player in the world."

[6] Messi became the first player to score five goals in a Champions League match in early March. By the end of 2012, he had scored 91 goals in club and international matches. Therefore, he broke one more record. In January 2013, Messi was named the FIFA Ballon d'Or winner for the fourth time!

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT

A. CHOOSE THE RIGHT ANSWER FROM THE LIST. (2 pts)

The text is mainly about:

1. Messi's biography
2. Messi's childhood
3. Messi's family

The right answer is: . . . . . .

B. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS. (3 pts)

1. Why did Messi's family move to Spain?

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

2. How much money does Messi earn each year?

. . . . . .

3. What did Messi achieve in 2012?

. . . . . .

. . . . . .

C. COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING SENTENCES. (2 pts)

1. The first team Messi played for was . . . . . .

. . . . . .

2. Maradona thinks that Messi . . . . . .

. . . . . .

D. FILL IN THE CHART WITH THE RIGHT INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

Year	Messi's awards and performances
2005	Messi put himself in the record books
. . . . .	Messi won the FIFA World Player of the Year.
2013	Messi. . . . .

E. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS THAT MEAN THE SAME AS: (3 pts)

1. expensive (paragraph 2): . . . . . .

2. fast (paragraph 3): . . . . . .

3. famous (paragraph 5): . . . . . .

F. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (3 pts)

1. native town (paragraph 1) :. . . . . .

2. team (paragraph 4) : . . . . . .

3. He (paragraph 5) : . . . . . .

LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

A. GIVE THE CORRECT FORM OF THE WORDS BETWEEN BRACKETS. (2 pts)

Hanane Al Fadili is a famous Moroccan (art) …… ; her performances always reflect great talent and (creative) ……

B. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD FROM THE LIST. (2 pts)

community - subject - illiteracy - local - higher

1. Narjiss hopes to continue her …… education in Montpelier for a PhD degree.

2. "Adult …… is an issue that should be given priority in our educational system"

C. PUT THE VERBS BETWEEN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT TENSE. (3 pts)

1. Laura went to the English club after she (finish) …… her homework.

2. "I (work) …… in this medical centre for more than ten years now," Doctor Wilson said.

3. By the end of 2015, the government (complete) …… the first part of the housing project.

D. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD FROM THE LIST. (2 pts)

where - whose - which - whom - who

1. The Wilsons celebrated their 20th wedding anniversary in the restaurant …… they first met.

2. Latifa lost the iPhone …… cost her 5000 DH.

E. REWRITE THE SENTENCES AS INDICATED. (2 pts)

1. Students must hand in the project work after the vacation.

The project work …….

2. "I'll come in the evening," Susan said.

Susan told me ……..

F. MATCH EACH EXPRESSION WITH ITS APPROPRIATE FUNCTION. (4 pts)

Expressions	Functions
1. For me, children should not watch horror films. 2. This washing machine is not only cheap but also efficient. 3. "Could you fix this wheel for me, please? 4. Nicole took a taxi so as to be in time for the interview.	a. purpose b. opinion c. request d. addition

1. . . . . 2. . . . . 3. . . . . 4. . . . . .

WRITING (10 pts)

Use the information in the chart to write a report for your school magazine about the 28th Marathon des Sables (the Sand Marathon) which was held in April 2013.

Aim of the Marathon	to collect money for the poor
Date	from April 5 to 15
Distance	about 240 km
Place	in the South of Morocco – near Ouarzazate
Race challenges	competitors carry basic supplies (food, clothes, medical kit, sleeping bag etc). water is distributed every 10 km
Participants	1017, men and women, aged 18 up to 80 years / from all over the world
Winners	women's race : Laurence Klein (France)
men's race	Mohamad Ahansal (Morocco)
Prize ceremony	winners received awards
Conclusion	your opinion about the event

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KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

CHOOSE THE CORRECT OPTION: (2 pts) 1. Messi's biography

WH QUESTIONS: (3 pts)

1. Because Barcelona offered Messi an opportunity to play for the team and pay his medical bills.
2. About (an estimated) $18 million a year.
3. He scored 91 goals in club and international matches (and broke one more record).

SENTENCE COMPLETION: (2 pts)

1. ...the Newell's Old Boys.
2. ...is very similar to him / is a leader / offers lessons in beautiful football / has something different from any other player.

CHART FILLING: (2 pts) **Year:** 2009
2013: was named the FIFA Ballon d'Or winner for the fourth time.

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (3 pts) 1. costly 2. rapid 3. renowned

WORD REFERENCE: (3 pts) 1. Rosario 2. Barcelona 3. Maradona

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

WORD FORMATION: (2 pts) 1. artist 2. creativity

GAP FILLING: (2 pts) 1. higher 2. illiteracy

VERB TENSES: (3 pts)

1. had finished (past perfect)
2. have been working (present perfect continuous)
3. will have completed (future perfect)

GAP FILLING: (2 pts) 1. where 2. which

REWRITING SENTENCES: (2 pts)

1. The project work **must be handed in (by students) after the vacation**.
2. Susan told me **(that) she would come in the evening**.

MATCHING: (4 pts) 1. b. opinion 2. d. addition 3. c. request 4. a. purpose

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

The following criteria should be respected while scoring the writing tasks.

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Writing: Use the information in the chart to write a report for your school magazine about the 28th Marathon des Sables (the Sand Marathon) which was held in April 2013: The 28th Marathon des Sables The 28th Marathon des Sables, also called the Sand Marathon, was held in the South of Morocco, near Ouarzazate, from April 5 to 15, 2013. Its aim was to collect money for the poor. The race was about 240 km long. It was a real challenge because competitors had to carry basic supplies such as food, clothes, a medical kit and a sleeping bag. Water was distributed every 10 km. A total of 1017 men and women, aged from 18 up to 80, took part from all over the world. Laurence Klein from France won the women's race, and Mohamad Ahansal from Morocco won the men's race. During the prize ceremony, the winners received awards. In my opinion, this was a great event because it combined sport with solidarity, and it showed the courage of all the participants.